Shi'as; Barelvis, Deobandis and Ahl-e-Hadith, intolerant elements and minorities.

How these components of existential threat theory have hit Pakistan is elaborated below.

ECONOMIC DOWNTURN

The economy suffered the most as the losses of foreign direct investment and tourism were indeed substantial. Until 2009, according to then Pakistani Foreign Minister Shah Mahmood Qureshi, Pakistan had suffered a monetary loss amounting to $34.5 billion dollars since 2001. The losses of $5 billion had been estimated in foreign direct investment, more than $5 billion in exports and $5.5 billion in privatisation (Cheema, 2009). 'It was documented that cumulatively terrorism had cost Pakistan around 33.02 per cent of its real national income for instance terrorism costs Pakistan around 1 per cent of real GDP per capita growth every year' (Mehmood, 2013).

Pakistan continued to pay a heavy price in economic and security terms. A large portion of its resources, both men and material, was consumed by this war over a decade. The economy was subjected to enormous direct and indirect costs, which continued to rise from $2.669 billion in 2001–2 to $13.6 billion by 2009–10 and to $17.8 billion in the financial year 2010–1.

Western countries, including the US, continued to impose travel ban for their citizens (investor, importers, etc.) to visit Pakistan. This adversely affected Pakistan's exports, diminished the inflows of foreign investment, disturbed the pace of privatisation programme, slackened the overall economic activity, reduced import demand, reduced tax collection, increased expenditure on additional security spending and affected domestic tourism industry. Besides the destruction of physical infrastructure (military and civil), terrorism caused great losses. In general, a massive surge in security-related spending was a strain on dwindling economy. The direct and indirect costs to the economy continued to rise further.

Pakistan's investment-to-GDP ratio nosedived from 22.5 per cent in 2006–7 to 13.4 per cent in 2010–1 with serious consequences on the job-creating ability of the economy (Economic Survey of Pakistan, 2010–11).